

THE EDIT ABROAD

Cape Town

The Luxury Packing Guide

V&A WATERFRONT · CAMPS BAY · WINELANDS · CAPE POINT

WELCOME TO THE EDIT

Cape Town — Where Mountains Meet the Ocean

Cape Town is one of the world's most dramatically beautiful cities — and one of the most varied in terms of what you'll need to wear. The Cape Doctor wind, the mountain hiking, the winelands, Camps Bay beach clubs, and the V&A Waterfront all require a different register, sometimes within a single day.

Summer (November–March) brings warm days, legendary sunsets over the Atlantic, and the kind of outdoor living that demands a wardrobe as versatile as the landscape.

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Cape Town is wild, beautiful, and endlessly surprising. Pack for all of it.

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YOUR DESTINATIONS

CAMPS BAY	WATERFRONT	WINELANDS	CAPE POINT
CB	VW	W	CP

BEST TIME TO VISIT

November through March is the Cape summer — warm, windy, and spectacular. December and January are peak season. November and March are warm with fewer crowds.

NOV Early summer, uncrowded	DEC–JAN Peak heat and season	FEB–MAR Golden late summer
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Her Edit — Cape Town Summer Wardrobe

Beach, wine farms, and dramatic sunsets

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

DAYWEAR

Linen or cotton sundress × 2
Quality swimsuit × 2
Wide-leg linen trousers × 1
Linen blouse × 2
Lightweight denim jacket × 1

EVENING & LAYERS

Slip dress (evenings) × 1
Knitwear layer (Cape Doctor wind) × 1
Safari-inspired neutral co-ord × 1
Linen shirt (tie-front or oversized) × 1
Bikini × 1

SHOES

Leather sandal — waterfront, markets, winelands
White sneaker — Cape Point walks and city exploring
Strappy flat or heeled sandal — Camps Bay sunsets and evening restaurants
Comfortable walking shoe — Table Mountain and Boulders Beach penguin colony

ACCESSORIES

HEADWEAR & JEWELLERY

Wide-brim hat (UV50+, also windproof)
Gold or semi-precious jewellery
Silk scarf (doubles as wind protection)

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Leather or woven tote (beach to wine farm)
Small crossbody (evenings)
Quality polarised sunglasses

HER CAPE TOWN STYLE PRINCIPLE

The palette: fynbos green, warm ochre, sandy neutral, ocean blue, warm white.
Always carry a layer — the Cape Doctor wind arrives without warning, even in summer.
The winelands require a slightly elevated look — sundress + sandal is perfectly appropriate.

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

CAMPS BAY



Swimsuit, linen shirt,
sandal, wide hat

WINELANDS



Linen co-ord,
leather sandal, sunglasses

SUNSET DINNER



Slip dress, strappy flat,
silk scarf for wind

His Edit — Cape Town Summer Wardrobe

Outdoors, adventurous, and effortlessly styled

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

TOPS & TROUSERS

Linen shirt (earthy tones) × 2
Quality swim trunks × 2
Chino shorts × 2
Lightweight hiking pants × 1
Cotton tee (quality) × 3

LAYERS & EVENING

Unstructured linen jacket (eve) × 1
Smart evening shirt × 1
Linen trousers × 1
Fleece or windbreaker (Cape Doctor) × 1
Board shorts (beach) × 1

SHOES

Leather sandal — waterfront and daytime
Hiking boot or trail shoe — Table Mountain is serious terrain
White sneaker — city and casual
Loafer or leather shoe — wine farm dinners and restaurants

ACCESSORIES

WARDROBE DETAILS

Quality polarised sunglasses
Minimal watch (waterproof)
Wide-brim or outdoor hat

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Backpack or canvas tote
Leather belt
Small leather bag (evenings)

DRESS CODE — BY OCCASION

Beach & pool:
Wine farm:
Restaurant:
Braai/outdoor:

Swim trunks, linen shirt, sandal — smart beach casual
Chinos or linen trousers, shirt, leather sandal — relaxed but considered
Smart casual — linen jacket or blazer appreciated at good restaurants
Comfortable layers — evenings cool quickly, even in summer

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

BEACH DAY



Swim trunks, open
linen shirt, sandal

WINELANDS



Chino shorts, shirt,
leather sandal

EVENING



Linen trousers, jacket,
leather shoe

BEAUTY & TOILETRIES

What to Bring

UV levels in Cape Town are extreme. SPF 50+ is non-negotiable year-round. The constant wind can dehydrate skin rapidly — rich moisturiser morning and evening.

HER BEAUTY BAG

SPF 50+ face (wind & sun)
Tinted SPF
Waterproof mascara
Bronzer + warm blush
Warm nude lip
Light perfume (not heavy in wind)
Rich hair oil (wind control)
After-sun body lotion

HIS GROOMING KIT

SPF 50+ face moisturiser
Cologne (not too strong outdoors)
Beard oil
Lip balm SPF
Rich hand cream (wind)
Deodorant
Hair paste
After-sun gel

ESSENTIALS & SMART TRAVEL

TECH & PRACTICALITIES

UK/EU Type M adapter (South Africa)
Portable charger
Reusable water bottle
Light windbreaker

THE EXTRAS THAT MATTER

South African Rand cash
Travel insurance (comprehensive)
Offline maps (signal in parks)
Reef-safe sunscreen

WHAT NOT TO PACK — EVER

Anything you can't carry comfortably — Cape Town involves hiking, walking, and wind
Excessive jewellery in public areas — situational awareness is important in any city
Light or fragile fabrics that can't handle the Cape Doctor wind
Formal shoes without grip — Table Mountain and coastal paths demand sensible footwear
Only warm-weather clothes — even summer evenings by the ocean can be genuinely cold

PACKING STRATEGY & CHECKLIST

Arriving in Cape Town

Stay in the V&A Waterfront area or Camps Bay — both offer beautiful bases.
 Book a Table Mountain cable car ticket in advance — queues and weather cancellations are common.
 Rent a car for the winelands — Stellenbosch and Franschhoek are non-negotiable day trips.
 The Cape Doctor wind starts most afternoons — plan outdoor activities for mornings.

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Table Mountain at sunrise. Atlantic sunset. Stellenbosch Chenin. Pack for all three.

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MASTER PACKING CHECKLIST

Print this page and tick each item as you pack.

HER CLOTHING	HIS CLOTHING	BEAUTY & GROOMING	EXTRAS & DOCS
☐ Sundress × 2 ☐ Swimsuit × 2 ☐ Linen trousers × 1 ☐ Linen blouse × 2 ☐ Denim jacket × 1 ☐ Slip dress × 1 ☐ Knitwear × 1 ☐ Safari co-ord × 1 ☐ Linen shirt × 1 ☐ Bikini × 1 ☐ Leather sandal ☐ White sneaker ☐ Strappy flat ☐ Walking shoe ☐ Wide-brim hat ☐ Crossbody bag	☐ Linen shirt × 2 ☐ Swim trunks × 2 ☐ Chino shorts × 2 ☐ Hiking pants × 1 ☐ Cotton tee × 3 ☐ Linen jacket × 1 ☐ Eve shirt × 1 ☐ Linen trousers × 1 ☐ Windbreaker × 1 ☐ Board shorts × 1 ☐ Leather sandal ☐ Hiking boot ☐ White sneaker ☐ Loafer/shoe ☐ Sunglasses ☐ Backpack	☐ SPF 50+ face ☐ Tinted SPF ☐ Waterproof mascara ☐ Bronzer ☐ Lip colour ☐ Perfume/cologne ☐ Hair oil ☐ After-sun ☐ Deodorant ☐ Beard oil ☐ Lip balm SPF ☐ Hand cream ☐ Face wipes ☐ Dry shampoo ☐ Power bank ☐ Reef-safe SPF	☐ Rand cash ☐ Passport ☐ SA adapter ☐ Travel insurance ☐ Reusable bottle ☐ Windbreaker ☐ Offline maps ☐ Kindle / book ☐ Camera ☐ Hotel confirmations ☐ Pain reliever ☐ Plasters ☐ Insect repellent ☐ Earplugs ☐ Eye mask ☐ Sunscreen stick